

Where Are We?

Status as at 1 October 2026. Steps 1 and 2 are complete. Three steps remain.

What we are building

A tool for investors. Someone picks a company they have invested in, answers a set of questions about it, and gets a risk score back. A second person then checks the score before anyone acts on it.

How the score works

Two things get combined.

1. How risky is this kind of business?

A chemical plant is exposed to safety and pollution problems. A software company mostly is not — but it is exposed to data privacy problems. This depends on *what the company does*, not how well it does it. We call this **exposure**.

2. How well does this company handle it?

Does it have a policy? Does it measure the problem? Does it have targets? Has anyone independently checked? This comes from the questions you answer. We call this **management**. Combine the two and you get **residual risk** — what is left over after management has done its job.

- > Think of driving. Exposure is how fast the car goes. Management is the brakes.
 - > A fast car with good brakes is fine. A fast car with no brakes is a disaster.
 - > A slow car with no brakes barely matters.
- High residual risk means escalate. Low means leave it alone.

What is done

Step	What it is	Status
1	The list of business types. 11 SASB sectors and 77 industries, taken from the official SASB standards.	Done, and you checked every code against the source
2	How risky each business type is. All 77 industries now carry their own weightings across 12 topics (924 numbers in total).	Done and working in the app

The app is also built: dashboard, questionnaires, live scoring, results, and a review workflow where one person submits, a second reviews, and a third approves.

The one caveat

You checked the *codes* — the names of the 77 industries. You have not checked the *weightings* — the 924 numbers that say how risky each topic is for each industry.

Those numbers were reasoned out, not taken from a published source. If they are wrong, every score the tool produces is wrong. This is the same kind of risk the codes carried before you verified them.

- > Analogy: the codes are the street names. You have confirmed the streets exist and are
- > spelled correctly. The weightings are the directions — we have written them down, but
- > nobody has driven the route to check they get you there.

What is left

1. **Check the weightings.** Confirm the numbers match how SASB describes each industry.
2. **Evidence tiering.** Right now, a company that *claims* it has a policy scores the same as one that can *prove* it. That should not be true.
3. **Backtesting.** Run the model against companies that are known to have had ESG failures. If it would not have flagged them, the model needs fixing.
4. **Move off the browser.** Data currently lives in one person's browser. It needs a proper database so a team can use it.

What you need to decide

Nothing is blocking. The question is order of work:

- Check the weightings now, before anyone relies on the scores, or
- Go straight to evidence tiering and come back to weightings later.

The first is safer. The second is faster.